THE KNIGHTLY ARTS



THE ART THAT DIGNIFIES

For ages knights have trained in various arts of battle, the most zealous knights have travelled far and wide to learn and challenge masters all over the world to perfect their ways of war. These knights have then taken it upon them to build systems of combat from the teachings they discovered from which they founded schools of their art.

MASTERS OF THE ART

To learn the knightly arts, you need to find a master that is willing to teach. To be accepted as a student you need to gain favour with his patron, pay him soundly, or impress him through virtue or deed. The requirement will depend on the specific master but beware also that most masters will not accept any student that is not already proficient in combat. (You cannot learn the HA's described in this tome unless being tought by a master. You need to match the skill level of the HA's they offer. Each master knows 3 skills, each skill takes a shift to learn and has to be rolled for with an advancement mark at the end of the session. Roll under highest weapon skill to succeed.)

HEROIC ABILITIES

STING OF THE VIPER

- **Requirement:** Any melee weapon skill at 16
- **Willpower Points:** 3

When a hostile monster or NPC moves within range of your weapon you may immediately use your action for the turn to perform a melee attack towards them.

COUNTER STRIKE

- **Requirement:** Dodge 16
- **Willpower Points:** 3

After a successful dodge roll you lunge your body forwards to perform a melee attack towards the attacker. This counts as a free action.

WRATH HEW

- **Requirement:** Any melee weapon skill at 16
- **Willpower Points:** 3

Activate when you declare a melee attack. You strike fast and true with murderous intent. The attack cannot be dodged and you add one extra dice to your damage bonus.

POMMEL STRIKE

- **Requirement:** Any melee weapon skill at 14
- **Willpower Points:** 3

Smash the butt of your weapon against the opponents head, dealing 2d6 bludgeoning damage. The opponent then need to pass a CON check. If that check is failed they are knocked prone and loose their action this turn. This ability does not work on monsters that are large or massive.

CROOKED HEW

- **Requirement:** Any melee weapon skill at 16
- **Willpower Points:** 3

Activate when you declare a melee attack. You step to the side and strike across towards the opponent. The attack cannot be parried and you may move 2 meters away from the opponent without suffering a free attack.

THWARTING STRIKE

- **Requirement:** Any melee weapon skill at 16
- **Willpower Points:** 3

Can be used instead of parrying an attack. You strike horizontaly with your weapon held high above your head, deflecting an incoming blow while striking at the same time. Roll a check for your weapon skill with a bane, if successful you hit the attacker with your weapon and parry simultaneously(do not roll for the attack).

COUP D'ÉTAT

- **Requirement:** Dagger 14, Brawling 16.
- **Willpower Points:** -

With haste you draw your sidearm after siezing a hold on your opponent. You can draw and attack with weapons with the subtle keyword when grappling an opponent.

THE CLOSE WAR

- **Requirement:** Any melee weapon skill at 14, grappling 14
- **Willpower Points:** 3

You skillfully parry an attack while moving in to grapple your opponent. After a successful parry roll you may immediately initiate a free grapple action even with a weapon equipped. if successful you drop your weapon to the ground unless it has the subtle keyword.

GRAPPLING BY THE WEAPON

- **Requirement:** Any melee weapon skill at 16, grappling 16
- **Willpower Points:** 3

You initiate a quick throw by using your weapon to lock your opponent and launch them to the ground. Roll your weapon skill or Brawling to perform this action. If this action is successful the opponent falls to the ground and you may follow up directly with a free melee attack towards the opponent.

NO MERCY FOR THE UNVIRTUOUS

- **Requirement:** Any melee weapon skill at 14
- **Willpower Points:** -

When performing a free attack due to an opponent disengaging. The attack automatically hits.

READ OPPONENT

- **Requirement:** Any melee weapon skill at 16
- **Willpower Points:** 3

For each turn attacking the same opponent, gain a boon on your attacks toward them. The effect persists until you attack another opponent or the opponent is slain.

MASTER TECHNIQUES

The following techniques can only be learned after learning all the previous knightly art HA's. The student has to find a legendary master of the art to learn the master technique HA's. These masters are scarce and hard to employ. Either they have grown tired of the petty plots of warring nobles and retreated to a life purely for the art itself or they are are exclusive to the highest orders of power in the land, employed at the houses of kings and emperors as personal teachers.

MASTER OF WEAPONS

- **Requirement:** 16 in at least 3 melee weapons and 18 in at least one more
- **Willpower Points:** -

You have truly mastered how to utilize any weapon and cross reference your knowledge of their different strengths. You lower the strength requirement by 3 of any weapon, can use any melee weapon skill when utilizing a melee weapon and score a Dragon on a roll of 1, 2, or 3.

TEMPO BREAK

- **Requirement:** Any melee weapon skill at 18
- **Willpower Points:** 3

You can swap initiative card with any opponent within 2m at any point during a turn before you have performed an action. You then gain a boon on melee attacks against that opponent until the end of the turn.

RELENTLESS FURY

- **Requirement:** Any melee weapon skill at 18
- **Willpower Points:** 3

You can perform one extra melee attack as a free action on your turn.

STALWART CHAMPION OF VIRTUE

- **Requirement:** 18 in at least two weapons
- **Willpower Points:** -

You possess an inner calm and are disciplined in both body and mind to the extent where you can conserve energy and balance to the point of perfection while fighting. Reduce the WP cost of all melee combat HA's by 1.

FENCING MASTERS



WHO ARE THEY?

Here follows a description of how to create fencing masters for your game of Dragonbane. Roll for their name, employment and personality. Then choose one or more of the means to apply for tutelage by the master. You could favorably choose the condition of tutelage that fits best with the employment and personality of the master. For example: a boastful master that is retired may want to have some real proof that you are worth his time.

D12	FIRST NAME	D12	FIRST NAME
1	Jurgen	7	Borgi
2	Gusano	8	Lasolei
3	Belico	9	Teodred
4	Furlani	10	Canrin
5	Hans	11	Folger
6	Johann	12	Aslan

D12	LAST NAME	D12	LAST NAME
1	Monteri	7	Darlindon
2	Randrath	8	Fendragon
3	Vati	9	Zikcha
4	Brechendaler	10	Ermich
5	Landeroa	11	Kel-Melen
6	Salerinda	12	Azfarath

D6	EMPLOYMENT
1	Hermit
2	Fencing Guild
3	Noble Court
4	Retired
5	Knightly Order
6	Army

D6	PERSONALITY
1	Boastful
2	Stoic
3	Generous
4	Impatient
5	Just
6	Ambitious

IMPRESSED BY DEED

A master that knows the true value of the art. To employ this master you need to show your worth. Ask the master what he requires of you, be it a quest or a display of your virtues. Some masters even demand to test your mettle in a duel.

BOUGHT WITH WEALTH

Not all masters are rich, and some always want to become richer. These masters will teach anyone at the right price. 100 Gold per shift is not uncommon for their classes.

TUTORSHIP AS FAVOR

Not all masters decide their own fate. Power covets skill and to employ a master that is not his own, either by lord, faith, or by oath, you may have to gain favour with their organisation to be taken as a student. Be helpful and make sure that your services are invaluable and even emperors will grant you favours.